

amongst themselves. The open source community abroad meets on various forums, including a lot of online forums and blogs, on which they discuss various technologies but it is not a common scenario in India. Open source professionals in India are not linked to each other, so a proper communication channel needs to be established. This channel helps in involving more and more people and in building a stronger community.

Q Do you feel India is rich in open source skills?

India has enough talent when it comes to open source skills but companies here are not ready to deploy open source technology solutions. In fact, the number of Windows systems administrators we get is less than the Linux sysadmins. So the talent pool is definitely there but the problem is that the software solutions providers or the companies into core development are more inclined towards development on proprietary platforms. Unless they do their developments on platforms like Perl, PHP or Java, they cannot move onto the Linux platform. Companies hosting their solutions on servers are not ready to accept Linux-based hosting platforms. They prefer proprietary hosting platforms. So the talent is not getting the right kind of boost, as the acceptance is not there from the corporate side.

Q What kind of hiring do you do when it comes to open source professionals?

We work on a lot of open source technologies, so the maximum number of people we have in our support staff work on open source technologies. Around 80 per cent of our employees work on Linux and open source platforms.

Q Do you think the availability of adequate open source talent is courtesy the changing education pattern in India?

No, unfortunately, that is not the case. There is not much inclusion of open source technologies in the syllabus, except for a few colleges. A few colleges across India have included some part of Linux in their curriculum but that is not enough to prepare an entire work force. The credit goes to the students who are self-driven and they manage to learn a lot. The Internet certainly has a major role to play in this learning. I am glad the awareness about open source has increased enough to interest youngsters, which is why they are thinking of venturing into this domain. Their interest, which is supported by some courses available like Red Hat certifications, helps in promoting open source technology amongst the youth.

Q Do you see an increase in the demand for open source professionals with this increasing awareness?

Globally, I see a major increase in the demand for open source professionals but India is still to catch up. The demand for open source professionals has definitely increased in the

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outsourced projects over the past few years but when it comes to the domestic projects, I do not see much of an increase.

Q What are the key open source tools that you use in your products?

We have many products and add-ons that we have developed on open source technologies. Our data centre management system is based on open source technology. It takes care of monitoring, managing and trouble shooting all the parameters for a data centre. So, right from re-booting or installing a server to assigning reverse DNS, forward DNS, monitoring, managing and trouble shooting, everything can be done online.

We also have developed a billing system for hosting. This has been developed in PHP to work on the Linux platform only. We have developed many such models which complement the open source technology. We have developed some free models as well, which are available online. Our eNlight platform is being positioned as a 'friend' of Linux. It comes with auto-scaling features like scaling of CPU and RAM. This is possible only in eNlight because of the fact that it is based on the Linux platform. So if you have a website that has got seasonal traffic, like that of a university, where results are declared only once in a year -- there are possibilities that the website will either slowdown or crash during the peak times. But if the website is hosted on eNlight, it will never crash. The number of CPUs and the RAM of your virtual machine will increase and will help your machine to grow in size, which will eventually help in serving the incoming traffic. All these add-ons that are done by our company complement open source technology. We use languages like PHP, Java and Perl to power our products.

Q How open are your clients to adopting open source solutions and has their attitude changed towards FOSS, of late?

Our end customers are happy adopting open source technology-based solutions. Most of the customers say that they want to host on Linux platforms. But companies that have developed their ERPs, or any other software, are not inclined to open source technologies. That is the saddest part of the open source story in India. 